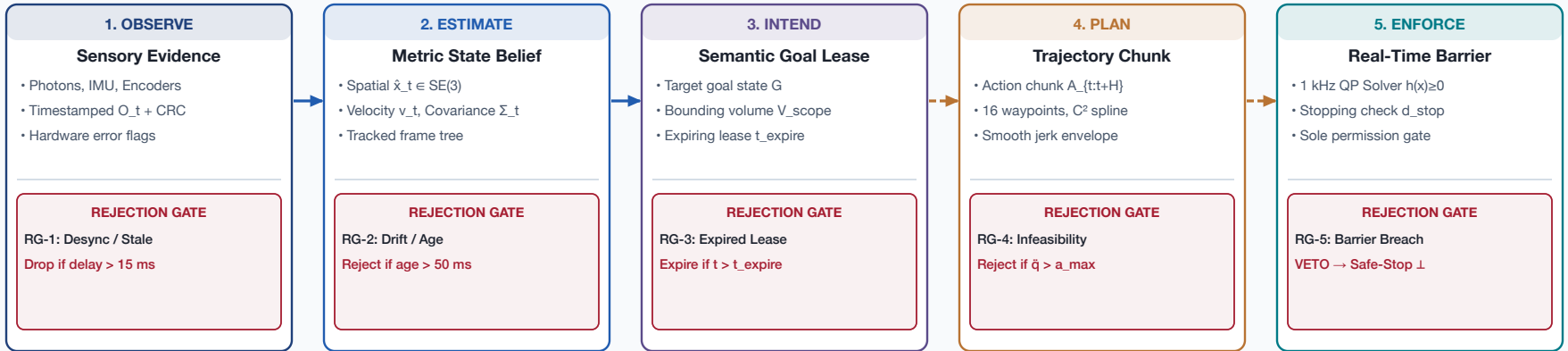


THE FIVE HANDOFFS: ARCHITECTURAL CHAIN & REJECTION GATES

Modular Functional Contracts with Interface Rejection Tests vs. Collapsed End-to-End Policy

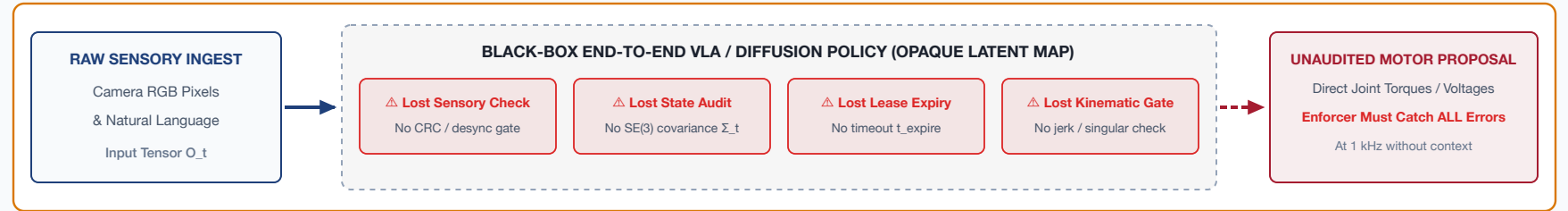
PANEL A: CANONICAL MODULAR CHAIN · EXPLICIT INTERFACE CONTRACTS & REJECTION GATES

PROPOSALS (DASHED) → PERMITTED ACTUATION (SOLID)



PANEL B: COLLAPSED END-TO-END POLICY · OPAQUE LATENT STATE & LOST INSPECTION INTERFACES

HIGH RISK: ZERO INTERMEDIATE REJECTION GATES



ARCHITECTURAL TAKEAWAY: COLLAPSING STAGES CONCEALS BUT DOES NOT ELIMINATE HAZARDS

Modular contracts allow each boundary to refuse invalid inputs before they consume compute or threaten physical safety.
An end-to-end model transfers the entire burden of sensory validation, state estimation, and lease audit onto low-level reflex filters.